

Asya Saydam

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Education

- 2027 **PhD, Sociology, University of Texas at Austin**
Certificate in Demography
Dissertation: *Counting on Each Other: Tacit Dependence and the Organization of Household Life* Co-Chairs: Shannon Cavanagh and Debra Umberson
- 2015 **MA, Modern Turkish History, Bogazici University, Istanbul**
Thesis: *Changing Retirement Patterns in Turkey: A Comparative Study of Metal and Municipal Sector Workers* Advisor: Ayşe Buğra
- 2013 **BA, Economics, Bogazici University, Istanbul**
Spring 2012: Erasmus Program at Corvinus University, Budapest, Hungary

Interests

Family · Gender & Sexuality · Health · Social Demography · Intimate Relationships

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Saydam, Asya and Hsu, Jaime. 2026. "Sleep Tight, Don't Fight? Daily Sleep Quality and Marital Strain in Same- and Different-Sex Marriages in the United States." Online first. *Journal of Health and Social Behavior*.

Cavanagh, Shannon and **Saydam, Asya**. 2025. "Maternal Depression Across Early Childhood: Similarities and Differences Across Three Liberal Democracies." Online first. *Journal of Health and Social Behavior*.

Saydam, Asya and Raley, Kelly. 2024. "Slow to Launch: Young Men's Parental Coresidence and Employment Outcomes." *Journal of Marriage and Family* 86(4):1009–33.

W. Parker Frisbie Outstanding Publication Award, UT Population Research Center 2024

Saydam, Asya. 2018. "The Incompatibility of Pension System and the Labour Market in Turkey." *Journal of Balkan and Near Eastern Studies* 20 (4): 332–48.

Selected Working Papers

Saydam, Asya. "Keeping the Ledger, Doing the Laundry: Tacit Dependence and Relative Earnings in Same- and Different-Sex Marriages" (*In Preparation for Submission*)

Honorable Mention Award, Norval Glenn Prize, UT Austin Department of Sociology, 2026

Saydam, Asya. "Counting on a Spouse: Tacit Dependence Across Household Domains and Marital Quality in Same- and Different-Sex Couples" (*Manuscript Available*)

Saydam, Asya. "The Sleep Cost of Housework: Nationally Representative Evidence from Same- and Different-Sex Couples in the United States" (*In Progress*)

Hsu, Jaime and **Saydam, Asya**. “Financial Stress, Social Support, and Depressive Symptoms in Same-Sex and Different-Sex Marriages” (*Manuscript Available*)

Mueller, Katie, **Saydam, Asya**, Rin Reczek and Mieke Beth Thomeer. “Beyond Happily Ever After: Dyadic Negotiations of Consensual Non-Monogamy Among Bi+ Adults in the United States” (*Manuscript Available*)

Thomeer, Mieke Beth, Hannah Lindl, Rin Reczek, Katie Mueller, and **Saydam, Asya**. “Mental Health Experiences within Sexual and Gender Diverse Long-Term Marriages” (*In Progress*)

Other Selected Publications

Public Scholarship and Media

Research featured in Dolan, Eric W. 2026. “Poor Sleep Quality Predicts Marital Strain, Especially for Women Married to Men.” *PsyPost*. June 2.

Saydam, Asya and Cavanagh, Shannon. “More Than Postpartum: Tracking Differences in the Arc of Maternal Depression Across Liberal Welfare Regimes”, *Council on Contemporary Families* December 2025.

Saydam, Asya. “Slow to Launch: Adult children living with their parents and employment outcomes”, *The Society Pages* June 2024.

Articles in Turkish

Saydam, Asya. “Artan Baskılar ve Kaçınılmaz Dönüşümler: Gençlerin Yaşayış Biçimleri Bizi Neden İlgilendiriyor?” [*Increasing Pressures and Inevitable Transformations: Why Do We Care About Young People’s Living Arrangements?*] (in Turkish), *Birikim*. January 2021.

Saydam, Asya and Çelebi, Elifcan. “Demografik, Sosyal ve Politik Dönüşümler Ekseninde Türkiye’de Aile ve Ailecilik Yazını” [*Family and Familialism Literature in Turkey in the Context of Demographic, Social and Political Changes*] (in Turkish), *Birikim*, Volume: 387-388, August 2021.

Saydam, Asya and Çelebi, Elifcan. “Olağan Yaşlılar: Yerli Dizilerdeki Yaşlı Karakterlere İlişkin Seyirci Algısı” [*Gendered Media Representations of Elderly Characters in Turkish TV Series*] (in Turkish), *Birikim*, Volume: 362, July-August 2019.

Edited Book Chapters

Saydam, Asya and Zeynep Kadirbeyoğlu. “Kent ve Kır Arasında Bağ Kurmak: Boğaziçi Mensupları Tüketim Kooperatifi (Bükoop) Deneyimi” [*Reconnecting the Urban and the Rural: An Alternative Food Network in the Boğaziçi Consumption Cooperative (Bükoop)*].” (in Turkish), in *Şehrin Doğası*, edited by Ayfer Bartu Candan, Cemal Kafadar, Suna Kafadar, and Çiğdem Kafescioğlu. Istanbul: *Metis*, (forthcoming 2026.)

Saydam, Asya. “Türkiye’de Değişen Emeklilik Biçimleri: Karşılaştırmalı Bir Perspektiften Metal Sanayi ve Belediye Sektörü İşçileri” [*Changing Retirement Patterns in Turkey: Metal Industry and Municipal Sector Workers in a Comparative Perspective*] (in Turkish), edited by Gülbiye Yaşar, Piyasa Hakimiyetinde Sağlık ve Sosyal Güvenlik, Publication: *NotaBene*, May 2017.

Fellowships, Honors & Awards

2026	Norval Glenn Prize, Honorable Mention , Department of Sociology, UT Austin	
2025–2026	University Graduate Continuing Fellowship , UT Austin	\$54,000
2025–2026	Equality Leaders Program Fellowship , Texas	
2025	Summer Writing Fellowship , UT Austin	\$7,000
2025	William Powers Jr. Endowed Scholarship , UT Austin	\$1,000
2024	W. Parker Frisbie Publication Award , Population Research Center, UT Austin	
2022	Distinction on Comprehensive Examinations , Demography and Family Sociology, UT Austin	
2021–2022	Pre-Dissertation Summer Fellowship , Department of Sociology, UT Austin	\$10,000

Selected Travel and Research Support

2024	Travel Fund Award , American Sociological Association	
2023	Travel Award , Population Research Center, UT Austin	
2023	Travel Grant , Families in Times of Accelerated Societal & Demographic Changes, University of Lausanne and University of Padova	
2022	Travel Award , Graduate Student Assembly, Department of Sociology, UT Austin	
2018	Research Support , Front Line Defenders	2,000 €
2016	Travel Award , Graduate Student Assembly, Boğaziçi University	

Selected Conference Presentations

“Airing the Household’s Dirty Laundry: Tacit Dependence and Relative Earnings in Same- and Different-Sex Marriages”

— *Poster*, **Work and Family Researchers Network**, Montreal, Canada, 2026

“The Sleep Cost of Housework: A Comparison of Same-Sex and Different-Sex Relationships in the United States”

— *Poster*, **Population Association of America**, St. Louis, MO, 2026

“Sleep Tight, Don’t Fight? Daily Sleep Health and Marital Strain in Same- and Different-Sex Marriages in the United States”

— *Paper*, **Population Association of America**, Washington, DC, 2025

“Changes in Physical Health and Housework Stress in Midlife Married Couples: Same-Sex and Different-Sex Unions”

— *Paper*, **American Sociological Association**, Montreal, Canada, 2024

“Household Work and Marital Quality: Exploring Perceptions of Dependence in Same-Sex and Different-Sex Marriages”

— *Paper*, **European Population Conference**, Edinburgh, United Kingdom, 2024

— *Poster*, **Population Association of America**, Columbus, OH, 2024

“Maternal Depression Across Early Childhood: Similarities and Differences Across Three Liberal Democracies”

— *Paper*, **American Sociological Association**, Philadelphia, PA, 2023

“Slow to Launch: The Association Between Young Men’s Coresidence with Parents and Employment Outcomes in Their Early Thirties”

— *Paper*, **Population Association of America**, New Orleans, LA, 2023

— *Paper*, **Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics**, Amsterdam, Netherlands, 2022

- “The 21st-Century Phenomenon of Household Arrangement: Solo Living Experiences in Turkey”
 — *Paper*, **Einstein Open Colloquium: Critical Turkey Studies**, Berlin, Germany, 2020
- “Changing Retirement Patterns in Turkey: Municipal and Metal-Sector Workers”
 — *Paper*, **Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics**, Berkeley, CA, 2016

Research Experience

- 2023–2025 **Health and Relationships Project**
 Graduate Research Assistant, Population Research Center, UT Austin
 NIH-funded, Principal Investigator: Debra Umberson
 Managed key components of HARP Wave 3, including survey implementation, participant retention, dyadic diary coordination, data management, and in-depth interviews with long-term bi+ couples.
- Summer 2023 **Work-Family Amenities and Women’s Job Choices**
 Research Assistant, Population Research Center, UT Austin
 Principal Investigator: Jennifer Glass
- 2021–2023 **Fertility Trends, Changing Maternal Characteristics, & Child Health**
 Research Assistant, Population Research Center, UT Austin
 NIH-funded, Principal Investigator: Shannon Cavanagh
 Longitudinal analyses using US (ECLS-B), UK (MCS), and Australian (LSAC) birth cohort studies examining maternal and child health.
- 2015–2017 **Development and International Economics**
 Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Marmara University, Turkey
- 2014–2015 **Social Policy Forum**
 Research Assistant, Boğaziçi University, Turkey
 Funding: Scientific Research Projects, Council of Higher Education
 Principal Investigator: Ayşe Buğra
 Comparative social policy research, analysis of World Development Reports and labor-market indicators, and qualitative research on retirement systems in Turkey.
- Summer 2015 **Market Reforms, Managerialism, and the Transformation of the Medical Profession in Turkey**
 Research Assistant, Providence College
 Principal Investigator: Tuğba Ağartan
 Conducted and coded interviews with physicians in Turkish public hospitals.
- Summer 2013 **Field Research, S360 Sustainability and Communication Services**
 Conducted interviews, surveys, and focus groups with community stakeholders for a social impact assessment of a proposed nickel mining project in Manisa, Turkey.

Professional Research Experience

- 2017–2020 **Research and Analytics Team Member**
 S360 Sustainability and Communication Services, Istanbul, Turkey
 Conducted social impact evaluations, stakeholder interviews, and focus groups, and developed Theory of Change and Social Return on Investment (SROI) frameworks for NGOs, social enterprises, and corporate partners.

Teaching Experience

	University of Texas at Austin, Department of Sociology
Fall 2026	<i>Global Health Issues and Systems</i> Instructor of Record
Fall 2025	<i>Health and Society</i> Instructor of Record Texas Prison Education Initiative (TPEI)
Fall 2025	<i>The Sociology of Health and Well-Being</i> Guest Lecturer “Systems of Healthcare Around the World”
Spring 2023	<i>Fertility and Reproduction</i> Teaching Assistant (Jennifer Glass)
Fall 2022	<i>Introduction to Social Statistics</i> Teaching Assistant (Jacob Cheadle)
Fall 2021–Spring 2022	<i>Social Research Methods</i> Teaching Assistant (Kelly Raley)
Spring 2021	<i>Introduction to the Study of Society</i> Teaching Assistant (Sarah Brayne)
Fall 2020	<i>Health and Society</i> Teaching Assistant (Stephanie Osbakken)
Fall 2016	<i>“From Research Interests to Questions”</i> Guest Lecturer Graduate Seminar, Boğaziçi University

Professional Development

June 2025	Berkeley Workshop on Formal Demography
January 2023	Families in Times of Accelerated Societal & Demographic Changes Organized by the University of Lausanne and the University of Padova Abano Terme, Italy
Fall 2022	Teaching Preparation Certificate <i>Teaching Preparation Series at the Center for Teaching and Learning</i> University of Texas at Austin
July 2022	Inclusive Classrooms Leadership Certificate <i>Division of Diversity and Community Engagement</i> University of Texas at Austin
September 2021	Social Sciences Data Carpentry Workshop The Carpentries, University of California, Davis
September 2019	Ethics and Politics of Research in Precarious Times Writing Society Workshop in Minerva Han Sabanci University, Istanbul, Turkey
June 2019	Mentor and Trainer <i>Social Impact Measurement</i> imece Incubation Program, Istanbul, Turkey

Professional and Community Service

Professional Service

- 2024–present Ad Hoc Reviewer, *American Journal of Sociology*; *Journal of Social Policy*; *Sociology Lens*
- Dec. 2023 Poster Selection Committee, Population Association of America Annual Meeting
- Fall 2021–Spring 2025 **Social Media Manager**
Council on Contemporary Families
Population Research Center, University of Texas at Austin

University and Community Service

- Fall 2023–Spring 2025 **Program Coordinator**
Refugee Student Mentor Program
Center for Middle Eastern Studies, University of Texas at Austin
Coordinated mentoring program connecting more than 100 university students with refugee youth.
- Fall 2022–Spring 2023 **Volunteer**, International High School
Refugee Student Mentorship Program, Center for Middle Eastern Studies
- Fall 2022–Spring 2023 **Student Minority Liaison**
Sociology Graduate Student Committee
- Fall 2021–Spring 2022 **International Student Representative**
Sociology Graduate Student Committee

Professional Associations

Population Association of America (PAA), American Sociological Association (ASA), Sociologists for Women in Society (SWS), Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE)

Technical Skills and Languages

Software: Stata, R, Mplus, NVivo, Qualtrics.
Turkish: Native, English: Fluent, Spanish and French: Beginner

References

- Shannon Cavanagh** Professor, Department Chair
Department of Sociology, University of Texas at Austin
✉ scavanagh@austin.utexas.edu
- Debra Umberson** Professor, Centennial Commission Professorship in Liberal Arts
Department of Sociology, University of Texas at Austin
✉ umberson@prc.utexas.edu
- Kelly Raley** Professor, Christie and Stanley E. Adams
Jr. Centennial Professorship in Liberal Arts
Department of Sociology, University of Texas at Austin
✉ kelly.raley@austin.utexas.edu
- Mieke Beth Thomeer** Professor, Pepper Schwartz
Medical School, University of Minnesota
✉ mthomeer@umn.edu